

N05 ARTIFICIAL INGREDIENTS | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Help individuals avoid artificial colors, flavors, sweeteners and preservatives in foods and beverages.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to label and phase out or restrict artificial ingredients.

Issue : Numerous artificial ingredients are typically added to highly processed foods to improve taste and extend shelf life.¹ However, since these additives do not add nutritional value to a food and tend to appear in foods with low nutritional quality, they should be avoided as often as possible. While some artificial ingredients do not carry immediate health risks, they may become toxic when consumed in large quantities and many have not been evaluated for their effects on metabolic regulation or potential contributions to obesity.² Certain artificial dyes that are approved for use in the U.S. may also be carcinogenic, cause hypersensitivity reactions and behavioral problems or be inadequately tested.³ In the EU, for example, foods that contain artificial dyes are required to carry label warnings that they may cause hyperactivity in children.^{4,5}

Solutions : Sourcing packaged foods and beverages without artificial colors, flavors, sweeteners and preservatives can help limit artificial ingredient consumption, as well as promote a diet of whole, natural foods. Labeling and phasing out the use of artificial ingredients that have been deemed ingredients of concern is another way to help individuals avoid consumption of additives. Fortunately, many food companies are phasing out artificial ingredients or reformulating recipes to remove them, a trend partly driven by growing consumer demand and an increased desire for nutritional transparency.⁶

PART 1 LIMIT ARTIFICIAL INGREDIENTS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Artificial ingredient phase out

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements:

- a. The project phases out (over a maximum of three years) the use, sale and provision of foods and beverages containing the following artificial ingredients:

Colorings	Blue 1 (E133), Blue 2 (E132), Green 3, Orange B, Citrus Red 2, Red 3 (E127), Red 40 (E129), Yellow 5 (E102), Yellow 6 (E110), carmine, cochineal, caramel coloring
Sweeteners	acesulfame-potassium (acesulfame-k), advantame, aspartame, calcium saccharin, saccharin, sucralose, cyclamate, neotame, polydextrose
Preservatives	sodium nitrate, sodium nitrite, potassium bromate, potassium iodate, propyl gallate, BHA (butylated hydroxyanisole), BHT (butylated hydroxytoluene), TBHQ, sodium benzoate
Fats & Oils	BVO (brominated vegetable oil), partially hydrogenated oil, olestra
- b. Foods and beverages are clearly labeled on packaging, nearby menus or signage to indicate whether they contain artificial ingredients listed in the table above.

OR

Option 2: Artificial ingredient restriction

The following requirements are met:

- a.

All foods and beverages sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis do not contain artificial ingredients listed in the table below:	
Colorings	Blue 1 (E133), Blue 2 (E132), Green 3, Orange B, Citrus Red 2, Red 3 (E127), Red 40 (E129), Yellow 5 (E102), Yellow 6 (E110), carmine, cochineal, caramel coloring
Sweeteners	acesulfame-potassium (acesulfame-k), advantame, aspartame, calcium saccharin, saccharin, sucralose, cyclamate, neotame, polydextrose
Preservatives	sodium nitrate, sodium nitrite, potassium bromate, potassium iodate, propyl gallate, BHA (butylated hydroxyanisole), BHT (butylated hydroxytoluene), TBHQ, sodium benzoate
Fats & Oils	BVO (brominated vegetable oil), partially hydrogenated oil, olestra

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